

[Skip to main content](#)[r/GooglePixel](#) ×

Search in r/GooglePixel



Create

**r/GooglePixel** • 12d ago
Probono_Bonobo

...

Did anyone else's "Hey Google" suddenly stop working this week?

A couple months ago I posted about [the issue with my Pixel's voice assistant suddenly refusing to make calls](#). Props to the Google team for reaching out and pushing a fix for the issue within a couple days. Really appreciated the quick response!

This week I'm having some trouble with a different issue on my Pixel that's once again preventing me from using the voice assistant. Namely it refuses to recognize when I say "Hey Google", which is something I probably use 10x/day. I didn't change any settings. I verified that the voice assistant/Gemini settings were correct and that it had permissions to activate from a lock screen (although the issue isn't specific to the phone being in a locked state).

Here's the truly weird thing: as I was troubleshooting the issue, I followed a recommendation to retrain the voice model. Easy enough, right? I've done this once or twice in the past before, no problem. You read a scripted line, the phone visualizes the audio with a kind of spectrogram effect, then verifies whether it can work with that input. If so, you move on to the next line. Repeat like 4 times.

Except this time, when I read the first prompt ("Hey Google, help me write a thank you note") there is *no* reaction from the system prompt. Zero. Zilch. Nada. The spectrogram is completely, 100% flat. And my first thought was "uh oh, is there a problem with the audio input?" Except that's impossible, because tapping the screen makes the interface turn various rainbow colors. It reacts quite strongly when I slide my finger across the microphone, and it even reacts to the quiet clicky sounds of me taking a screenshot using the side buttons. But when I read the voice line? Zero reaction whatsoever. Reminds me of a cat I had once.

Since I couldn't complete the exercise to retrain the voice model, the "Hey Google" functionality is now forcibly disabled. I didn't want to disable it, but since it couldn't identify my voice, I had to hit the "Cancel" button. And when you hit the "Cancel" button it asks if you're sure, and that "Hey Google" activation will be disabled for all of your Google devices unless you complete the training exercise. So now the feature I rely on most is once again broken in an utterly bizarre, mysterious way, and I have no idea how to even troubleshoot the issue because the symptoms are so unusual that the ordinary troubleshooting steps don't even work correctly.

I switched to the Pixel 3 many years ago because I was so frustrated with Siri. I'm on the Pixel 9 now, and when it works it's everything that I want in a phone. But they really need to take the issues with the voice assistant seriously, or I'll be considering replacing this with an iPhone soon.



5



4

Share

**TestinyApp** • Promoted

...

Test management that doesn't suck. Lightweight, fast, and built for real dev teams.

**TESTINY**

Easy to use. Lightning fast.
Supports test automation.
Integrates with any tool.
Use in cloud or on-premises.



Create



Join the conversation

Sort by: Best ▾

Search Comments



skibik1964 • 11d ago

Pixel 9a

About 3-4 months ago my P9A stopped responding to "Hey Google" when I was trying to set a simple timer. I would say "Hey Google" and it would act like it was listening but it would not respond to any command no matter what I asked it to do. I was trying the same thing, delete trained voice and retrain, even tried clearing cache and storage and nothing. I gave up then I the next day I tried again by going to settings, apps, Gemini, cleared storage and cache, restarted my phone, opened up Gemini settings and turned on "Hey Google" and followed the prompts to retrain voice and it has been working ever since. The first night trying everything I could think of the one thing I never did was restart the phone between clearing the app and retraining my voice, not sure why that needs to be done but I got it to work again.



Probono_Bonobo OP • 11d ago

Yeah unfortunately there's a bug or glitch with the voice retraining module (described above) that prevents it from picking up my voice. Specifically my voice. It picks up background noise, but not my voice. Weirdest thing I've seen in a while.



Busy_Somewhere6142 • 9d ago

Mine never has worked well. It's been sporadic. I've given up. Soon as I can I'm going back to iphone



docxp • 8d ago

Pixel 7 here.

I've been using hey google for 3 years with the occasional hiccup, nothing retrying or rebooting wouldn't solve. Since last week it doesn't respond to hey google anymore. The hey google sensitivity settings reports that the function is not available for the current device